EDITION 01

The Economic Actor with No Passport

Every payment system on earth was built for a creature with a social security number. What happens when the buyer is an LLM?

A **6**-part breakdown

SWIPE >>>>

0101 / 06

The Next Economic Powerhouse Has No Identity.

By 2027, millions of transactions will be executed entirely by software agents. They don't have physical bodies, government IDs, or home addresses.

0202 / 06

The KYC Chokepoint.

Traditional Know-Your-Customer rules require passports or corporate registries. If an AI agent cannot pass identity verification, it cannot open a traditional bank account.

0303 / 06

Why Plastic Cards Fail Software Agents.

Credit cards assume human gatekeepers and physical security. An AI agent routing transactions over standard 16-digit plastic numbers creates a massive surface area for credential leaks.

0404 / 06

The Rise of Non-Human Wallets.

We are moving away from traditional bank accounts toward cryptographic, programmatic wallets. These environments are purpose-built for machine-to-machine value transfer.

0505 / 06

The Shift From Identity to Authorization.

Banks must stop asking ***who*** the entity is, and start verifying ***what code*** authorized the spend. Cryptographic proofs are replacing the physical signature.

0606 / 06

Who Will Build the Bank for AI?

The dominant financial institutions of the next decade won't be the ones with the prettiest retail branches—they will be the ones with the most robust, developer-friendly machine banking APIs.

THE TAKEAWAY

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◆ Joseph Bankole